

Common Questions

Below are answers to frequently asked questions about the course project.

Deliverables

Q: What are the requirements for presentation slides?

A: There is **no required template or format** for slides, and you do **not** need to spend time making them fancy. You can even submit a simple outline — anything that clearly shows what you plan to present is sufficient.

The only purpose of submitting slides or an outline is **for fairness**: **all teams should present only what they have completed by November 17**. The submitted slides/outline allow us to verify that everyone follows this rule.

If you choose to create slides, make sure they are easy to read and follow. Avoid using fonts that are too small — this is not a vision test for your classmates.

Q: Are there any specific version requirements for libraries or frameworks?

A: There is **no strict requirement** on which versions you use for React, Expo, or any other library. As long as your app runs correctly and meets all project requirements, you are free to choose versions.

We **encourage you to use the latest stable versions**, because newer versions usually offer better stability, improved developer experience, and fewer compatibility issues on real devices.

When grading, we will run `npm install` using your `package.json` and `package-lock.json`. As long as these files are correct and allow your project to build and run, the exact versions you used are fine.

Q: Do we need to deploy our backend to a paid cloud hosting service?

A: No, deployment to a paid cloud hosting service is **not** required.

For this course project, every team must:

- Integrate a backend service or API, and
- Provide a testable mobile build using Expo EAS Build.

If your team builds a custom backend, the following setup is completely acceptable:

- Your mobile app is built with Expo EAS Build
- Your backend runs locally during testing
- Your video demo demonstrates full functionality
- Your README includes clear instructions for running the backend locally

You're welcome to deploy your backend using any free-tier service, but doing so is optional.

Presentation

Q: Do we have to present slides during the presentation?

A: No, you can explain your work verbally if you prefer. Slides are just an aid — use them if they help clarify your presentation, but you are not required to.

We recommend using slides when presenting your plan for implementing advanced features (if they aren't finished by November 17), as this makes your presentation easier to follow. If your advanced features are already completed, you can simply demo them with a verbal walkthrough.

Q: Do all team members need to present?

A: No. Each team may choose 1–2 presenters, but all team members must attend both sessions to provide peer feedback.

We encourage all team members to present, as this is an opportunity to practice your presentation skill — an asset that will be useful in the workplace.

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